individual interest ahead of team interest. However, in a situation where there was no chance of winning the match, it was essential to give both batsmen a chance to get their hundreds. I convinced Gary that it was the right thing to do for the team and was glad that he agreed with me.

Unfortunately, however, both Yuvraj and Gautam missed their hundreds. Yuvi was run out for 86 and then Gautam was out for 97, which was when we finally declared the innings at 251–7. Soon afterwards, I joked with Yuvraj and Gautam, complaining that I had delayed the declaration for them both and yet they had not scored their hundreds. In fun, I said to Yuvraj, '*Tumhe mein ek laath dunga, tum run out ho kar aaye for 86 aur maine tumhare liye declaration ko roka!*' (I will kick you. I stopped the declaration for you and you got run out for 86!)

A series win to remember

In the end it took us just thirty minutes on the final day to wrap up that first Test at Multan in 2004. Before that I had had a part to play with the ball against Pakistan wicketkeeper Moin Khan. I had dismissed Moin before in exhibition games and started playing mind games with him, telling one of my team-mates, '*Main ise pehle bhi out kar chuka hoon. Aaj bhi yeh main isko out karunga.*' (I have dismissed him before and today also I will get him out.) Moin heard the conversation and smiled at me, saying, '*Aaj toh main tujhe chakka marunga.*' (Today I will hit you for six.) I told him that I promised to flight the ball, so '*Chalo mar ke dikhao.*' (Come on, try and hit me.) Then I shouted to my team-mates to give Abdur Razzak a single and get Moin back on strike. For the last ball of the day, I decided to bowl him a googly, because he was trying to pad up to every delivery. The ball pitched on off stump, turned exactly as I had hoped and went through his legs to hit leg stump. It was a key wicket and helped to swing the momentum in our direction. In the second Test at Lahore, however, we were outplayed. Though Yuvi scored a very good hundred for us, we were always playing catch-up and were never in the contest.

The third and deciding Test at Rawalpindi started on 13 April. Sourav was back in the side and to maintain balance we decided to open with Parthiv. Lakshmipathy Balaji and Irfan Pathan, our two swing bowlers, bowled very well throughout the series and this match was no different.